



the last year. Post the tournament in Chennai, the side won a gold medal at the Asian Games in Hangzhou, one of the qualifying events for the Paris Olympics. Last month, at the Summer Games, the Indian team clinched its second straight bronze medal.

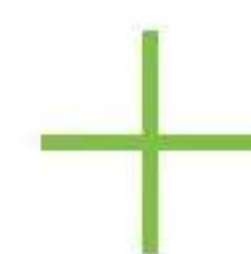
It was the only Asian outfit amongst the 12 participants and turned out to be the only side that did not lose its place on the podium from Tokyo 2020. It also gives perspective to the increased gap between the tricolour nation and other Asian nations in terms of efficient and high-quality hockey.

Showing no signs of a potential hangover, the Indian team has begun the new Olympic cycle in an emphatic fashion.

For the Asian Champions Trophy, coach Fulton retained 10 players and three reserves — goalkeeper Krishan Bahadur Pathak, defender Jugraj Singh, and midfielder Nilakanta Sharma — from the squad that competed in Paris. He chose to rest five players: Hardik Singh, Mandeep Singh, Lalit Upadhyay, Shamsher Singh, and Gurjant Singh. Hardik had sustained an injury on his left hand during the bronze medal match against Spain.

Additionally, a change was necessitated by the retirement of veteran goalkeeper P.R. Sreejesh. The remaining spots in the squad were filled by Suraj Karkera, Mohd. Raheel Mouseen, Arajjeet Singh Hundal, Uttam Singh, Gurjot Singh, and Amir Ali, all of whom had been

Indian men's hockey team retained its Asian Champions Trophy crown with a 1-0 win over China in the final in Moqi. This was India's fifth Asian Champions Trophy title. PTI



(Rankings as of September 17, 2024)

India - 5th
Malaysia - 13th
Korea - 14th
Pakistan - 15th
Japan - 16th
China - 23rd